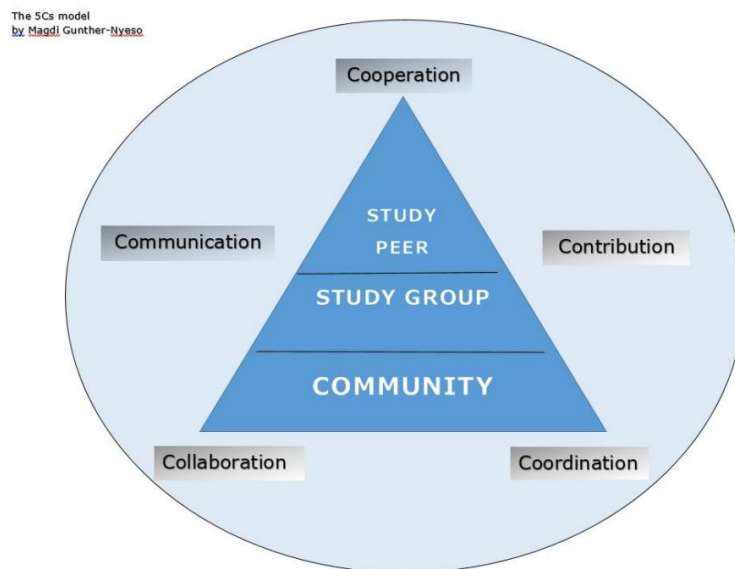


What is SJ?

Study Jam is an event where all students come together for a specified period of time to work through their coursework. Continuous technical support is provided during a Study Jam by way of student volunteers. Also, webinars, workshops and Q&A sessions are created and hosted by the community for the community. The Goal is to help each other learn in new and exciting ways.

By adapting the 5Cs that my friend and mentor (Magdi) introduced to me: communication, collaboration, contribution, Cooperation and Coordination, this can certainly be achieved.



December

Nether organising such event on this scale, I had doubts that I would not be able to make a Study Jam happen and be successful. First thought was that yes, I could host a small webinar, or co-host a webinar. This nether happened in fact, the thoughts of hosting a single session turn out to be the full organisation of Study Jam!

After several meets with my friends we started to float around ideas, this started off with simple thoughts of: Alumni Q&A, Career Session, 24hrs Tech support, and some Quizzes, and a lookback wall to share a memorable moment amidst the chaos of 2020. Then a big IDEA was dropped into the group, Lets invite prominent keynotes and data experts to see if they will present for the Study Jam.

The Study Jam Date based on the calendar was indication of Friday 22nd January 2021. At first announced the Idea but had very little response, and felt quite disappointed, this could have been due to the time in December of the first announcement and the locality being only in the Student Lead channel. Waited for a few more days but not much greater response.

With such great ideas, and the thought of little interest started to create even more doubts.

Magdi was already in the process of reaching out to Scott Taylor: The Data Whisperer and Alumni, and other personalities, to come share their knowledge. I was already in contact with a prominent data personality for the Study Jam but unfortunately this was a dead end.

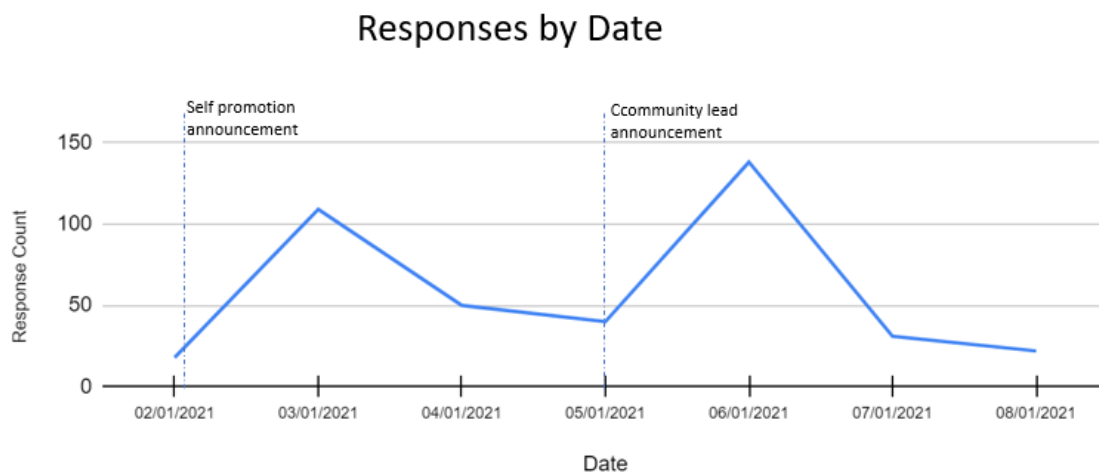
Then we struck Gold, Confirmation of Scott Taylor – The Data Whisperer accepted our invitation to the Study Jam, was great news and spirits were lifted.

January 2nd (3 weeks till event)

Again more doubts were being casted and the feeling off not even getting the first foot of the ground was quite painful, come January Esma a fellow scholar, who would help me in organise the study jam, sent out consensus to get some vibe going for the community and which date would be most popular for a Study Jam. Again, this did not have the desired impact.

Also reaching to invite more guest speakers, even reach out to Alteryx, these paths also did not lead to much success towards our goal, All these setbacks started to add up and felt so disappointing at the time, and thought of what can we full back on, what should we consider. Do we just revert to hosting one or two webinars?

After reaching out to the community leads from Udacity, we started to see some Magic happen. Below you can see where we tried to engage the community for the Study Jam and where the community lead announcement made the impact. This gave a boost of confidence after the initial slow response.



January 9th (2 weeks till event)

By the time we were able to decide the date another week had past, and we ran into a dead end for a guest speaker. We could now confirm the date and start time to be Saturday 23rd at 08:00 GMT, and run for 24hours, through to 08:00gmt Sunday 24th of January. The Study Jam Poster was created and used it promote the event. Was great to see that we had a least 430 responses for the date. The next challenge was how do will provide enough activities for the 24hrs.

After our dead ends, we certainly we wanted to invite more guest speakers, to make this an event to remember. More emails went out inviting some well know industry characters. We were able to get the attention of Susan Walsh – The Classification Guru happily accepted our invitation.

The feeling is overwhelming when you can get know personalities to take time to share their knowledge and experience. Now we had an additional speaker. But We still no platform that we were able to host on that would allow greater than 100 attendees. Being such prominent figures, we wanted as many scholars to be able to attend as possible and not miss out on such a great opportunity.

Seeing if we could get support from Udacity, to potentially being able to leverage their Zoom, this was asked. (more on this later).

We now have a date to commit to the Udacity Alumni and our guest speakers, (sending out the promotion flyers would happen in the final week) and a bit of community teaser mentioning that we have them on board but the reveal would come later.

More planning was needed in regards to the day it self, looking for volunteers to help on the , a channel monitoring program was created with times where mostly Student Leads would help with the announcements in the #Study_Jam channel. After several meet ups we were finally able to get coverage for the 24hrs.

STUDY_JAM CHANNEL MONITORING SIGN-UP SHEET									
Please select a timeslot for you to monitor #study_jam channel									
Saturday January 23rd 1:30 PM IST - Sunday January 24th 1:30 PM IST									
Saturday January 23rd 8 AM GMT - Sunday January 24th 8 AM GMT									
Saturday January 23rd 12 AM PST - Sunday January 24th 12 AM PST									
IST	GMT	PST	PERSON 1	PERSON 2	IST	GMT	PST	PERSON 1	PERSON 2
1:30 PM - 2:30 PM	8 AM - 9 AM	12 MIDNIGHT - 1 AM	Jonathan	birozso	1:30 AM - 2:30 AM	8 PM - 9 PM	12 NOON - 1 PM	Jonathan	Eema
2:30 PM - 3:30 PM	9 AM - 10 AM	1 AM - 2 AM	Eema	birozso	2:30 AM - 3:30 AM	9 PM - 10 PM	1 PM - 2 PM	Jonathan	Eema
3:30 PM - 4:30 PM	10 AM - 11 AM	2 AM - 3 AM	Jonathan	Eema	3:30 AM - 4:30 AM	10 PM - 11 PM	2 PM - 3 PM	Rachel_Kam	Gurpreet Kaur
4:30 PM - 5:30 PM	11 AM - 12 NOON	3 AM - 4 AM	Jonathan	Ankita Ghosh	4:30 AM - 5:30 AM	11 PM - 12 MIDNIGHT	3 PM - 4 PM	Rachel_Kam	Gurpreet Kaur
5:30 PM - 6:30 PM	12 NOON - 1 PM	4 AM - 5 AM	Eema	Ankita Ghosh	5:30 AM - 6:30 AM	12 MIDNIGHT - 1 AM	4 PM - 5 PM	Jessy	Gurpreet Kaur
6:30 PM - 7:30 PM	1 PM - 2 PM	5 AM - 6 AM	Eema	birozso	6:30 AM - 7:30 AM	1 AM - 2 AM	5 PM - 6 PM	Jessy	Gurpreet Kaur
7:30 PM - 8:30 PM	2 PM - 3 PM	6 AM - 7 AM	Ankita Ghosh	birozso	7:30 AM - 8:30 AM	2 AM - 3 AM	6 PM - 7 PM	Jessy	David B
8:30 PM - 9:30 PM	3 PM - 4 PM	7 AM - 8 AM	Jonathan	birozso	8:30 AM - 9:30 AM	3 AM - 4 AM	7 PM - 8 PM	Jessy	David B
9:30 PM - 10:30 PM	4 PM - 5 PM	8 AM - 9 AM	Jonathan	Ankita Ghosh	9:30 AM - 10:30 AM	4 AM - 5 AM	8 PM - 9 PM	Jessy	David B
10:30 PM - 11:30 PM	5 PM - 6 PM	9 AM - 10 AM	Prachi Gupta	Jim Loric	10:30 AM - 11:30 AM	5 AM - 6 AM	9 PM - 10 PM	David B	birozso
11:30 PM - 12:30 AM	6 PM - 7 PM	10 AM - 11 AM	Prachi Gupta	Jim Loric	11:30 AM - 12:30 PM	6 AM - 7 AM	10 PM - 11 PM	Ankita Ghosh	birozso
12:30 AM - 1:30 AM	7 PM - 8 PM	11 AM - 12 NOON	Eema	Jim Loric	12:30 PM - 1:30 PM	7 AM - 8 AM	11 PM - 12 MIDNIGHT	Jonathan,	Prachi Gupta

During this week we also released the question form to get scholars to submit their questions for the Career Q&A session, and shared the volunteer form to allow scholars to host webinars/ workshops or be available for Tech_ama. Also released “The Look Back Wall 2020” as an interim activity to continue into the day its self.

After seeing how little impact the self promotion did to get the ideal date to host the Study Jam, we swiftly moved towards the community leads to get the volunteer form on the announcement channel. We also got a special #study_jam_volunteers’ channel so we could communicate and coordinate for the study jam event.

Volunteer request starting filtering through adding their contribution, but the majority at first were for Tech_AMA support, Question to myself was how we were going to fill up the 24hr event. After collaborating with the study Jam channel monitoring support, we started to promote again and started to reach much more of the community. The was awesome to see we started to get requests to host webinars and workshops that varied in topics.

Next up was deciding what would our them song be, and our slogan. Ideas started to roll on in and was decided.

Them song: **Imagine Dragons - Believer**

Slogan: **“TOGETHER IS FAR BETTER; WE CAN GO FURTHER!”**

January 16th (1 week till event)

January the 16th My Birthday, but got a great surprise on this day....

Dave Langer excepted the invitation to be part of the study jam, another motivational and overwhelming feeling not wanting to let people down, now I seemed to be outside my comfort zone, First time organising an event of such calibre, community already aware and guest speakers already accepted,

"I want to stop.....
We can't!"

To make this study jam to be one of the greatest was to remember, I needed to continue.
In the final week to do list.

- flyers for guest speakers
- master schedule
- tech_ama schedule
- study jam package containing all the details for the day.
- webinar platform

Emotions running high and still so much to do, create flyers send on for approval. Which lucky they all agreed. Keeping the momentum going we had to promote the different events. This was conducted daily through my #60_day_challenge (challenge where you commit at least 30 minutes a day to study and share what you achieved). Luckily, I could turn to Scholar from the previous scholarship program Nishant: he is Mr. Study Jam from the first round, who lead a team of peers who organized 2 jams!

Creating the master schedule was great, put my organisation skills to the test, I had to be sure that we were cover the 24hrs with activities, and the majority webinars / work shops Q&As were an hour long. This at times required me to contact the host to see if there was any flexibility to move their suggested time to another free time slot, keeping in mind that his was a global community, this enabled another of the 5Cs. Cooperation. There were few times where we needed to run webinars in parallel.

The final Master schedule included start times, hosts, topics, descriptions and links for the events.

E	F	G	H	I	J	K
23rd Jan	23rd Jan	23rd Jan				
24th January IST / GMT						
IST	GMT	PST	Event	Topic	Recording / Extras	Duration
1:30 PM - 2:30 PM	8 AM - 9 AM	12 MIDNIGHT - 1 AM	Webinar	STUDY JAM KICK OFF	Meeting Recording	30 mins
2:30 PM - 3:30 PM	9 AM - 10 AM	1 AM - 2 AM	Workshop	Perform Data Analysis in Seconds!	Doc	45 mins
3:30 PM - 4:30 PM	10 AM - 11 AM	2 AM - 3 AM	Q&A session	Understand the logic of data	Not Recorded	2 hours
			Workshop	Web Scraping	Meeting Recording	20 mins
			Workshop	Data Viz with Tableau- an Introduction	Not Recorded	1 hour
4:30PM - 5:30 PM	11 AM - 12 NOON	3 AM - 4 AM	Q&A session	Udacity Alumni AMA	Meeting Recording	1 hour
			webinar	Data Visualization with Tableau (Accessing the Student Tableau Free Subscription	Not Recorded	30 mins
5:30 PM - 6:30 PM	12 NOON - 1 PM	4 AM - 5 AM	Webinar 12:00	AI, Data Science and Machine Learning: A Brief Introduction	Meeting Recording	40 mins
6:00 PM - 6:30PM	12:30 - 1 PM	4:30 AM - 5 AM	Webinar 12:30	Transforming Your Work Environment With Data Analytics	Meeting Recording	30 mins

Each weekday we revealed who the guest speakers were, and this got the community motivated for the Study Jam.

January 20th (3 days remaining)

Back to the Udacity Zoom platform, why were we after this? We could have maximum capacity of 1000 attendees given everybody a chance to join, we record and seamless event.

It was now realised that there were many stoppers to leverage this idea, community lead would need to be online at all times, and recordings would be bound to Udacity.

So, what now? What's our next steps? We needed a platform to give as many scholars as possible a chance to attend the guest speakers and other events. So, I started looking around various platforms. And a lot of them only allowed 25 max attendees and limited to up to 40minutes or less.

Another day is parsing with yet a solution to find. This made me feel very disappointed and anxious to find a hosting platform, could there be one out there that met the requirements just for this single 24hr period?

The channel monitors and volunteers helping to promote the events continued and could start to feel the community welcoming the study jam.

January 21 (2 days remaining)

We were able to find alternative platform that met our needs and more on a free trial, host up to 500, multiple speakers, chat, screenshare, recording. And we could even and banner branding. Along with Magdi & Esma we started to explore and get familiar with the platform. So now we had a usable platform, Myself & Esma asked the community to flood a test room to check stability, but this was not to be, so we needed to hope for the best on the day.

All different webinar sessions were created sent to the guest speakers and Alumni, and the master schedule updated. Time closing in for the actual day still needed to finalise the stud jam package, and provide all the links to the schedules, and proofread.

For the first in the whole organisation of the study jam it actually started to be realised. This was a great sense of achievement overcoming many of challenges that were faced.

Also held a session with the channel monitoring volunteers for the tasks ahead on the day, making announcements 15 minutes and 2-3minutes before a webinar was going to start and keep the momentum going through 24hrs.

January 22 (Last day)

Last day for preparation, could now release the final master schedule, schedule for the Tech_AMA volunteers, and the study jam Package. We had few late additions to add, a Bingo activity where scholars could cross out their grid based on activities during the study jam, a special Bertelsmann Technology Data track playlist for scholars to add and relax while listening and a graphic for an emoji for the slack.

Grace the community lead, was making the announcement with everything we prepared for the day, and even created a webpage for the study jam.

<https://sites.google.com/udacity.com/bertelsmann-tech-scholarship/data-track/data-study-jam>

With everything set was time to sleep. But there were still thoughts ongoing.

Will everything go smooth as I would like?
What if there are technical issue how will we overcome them?
Is the information to the community correct and understandable?
We will have delay and how to handle them?

January 23, Study Jam!

My Day started early at 06:00 GMT+1 and making all last-minute checks ready to kick of the Study Jam, checked in with the Channel Monitors, they were ready to go, to provide full support.

Esma, and I ready for the kicked off the study jam right on time at 08:00 GMT. We Are showing the amazing line up of events the community had made, and finished off with them song, leading the way for the first event.

The day went smoothly, and the community was buzzing, alive enthusiastic so much energy from hosts to attendees and all the supporting volunteers. Announcements to the up coming events all on time. This was a great feeling I felt relaxed and was able to enjoy the day to its fullest, meeting scholars in a different light learning and growing together and seeing what we are all capable of achieving.

We had total 16 Alumni from all around the globe gathered together (including myself and Magdi) to share their life stories, tips and advices and showcase what learning meant together. This was a huge success and well received by scholars on this community.

The 3 prominent guest speakers where awesome sharing their professional insights. Was well received and their presentations gave great value in the topics of:

Data Management

Dangers of Dirty Data

Data Literacy

We had over 30 webinars, with over 500 attendees for the day. The guest speakers where the first ever to be hosted in a study Jam. An amazing feat!

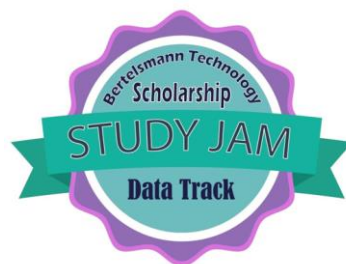


Image by Susyjam

Final Thoughts

This event really showed how that we are able to communicate, collaborate, contribute, Cooperate and Coordinate with a global community.

I have learnt that when there are obstacles that get in the way, see this as an opportunity to explore a different route to achieve our goals.

Did I do enough on the first attempt to promote the study jam seeing we had little responses, or was I limited by the slack platform not being able to reach the whole community with a single message like the community leads? Or was it the way of promotion and the initial message? Would be interesting to find out.

During this journey I have built a foundation and confidence that I am able talk to a broader audience and able to organize on a much larger scale than a normal office meeting.

To end this journey, I would like to show my appreciation with big THANK YOU,

Esma, for being a great co-host / organiser.

Magdi, mentoring and advices along the way.

Nishant, for helping with documentation.

Scott Taylor – The Data Whisperer

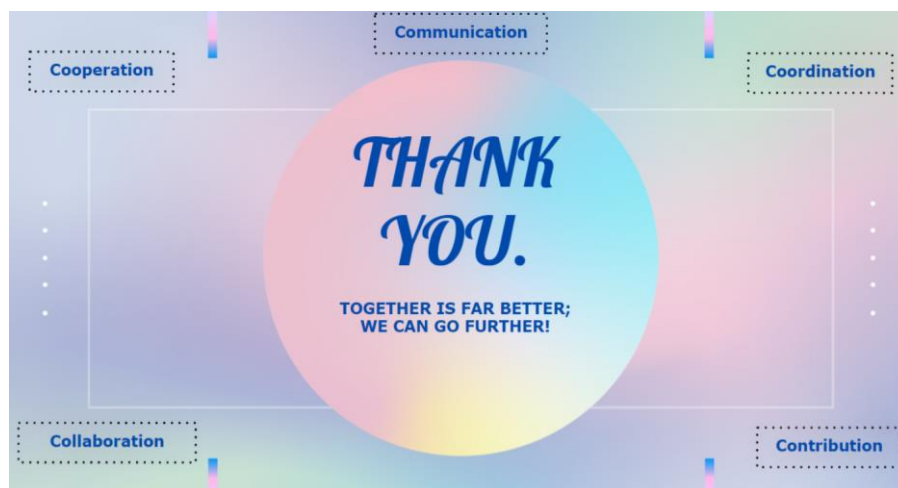
Susan Walsh – The Classification Guru

Dave Langer – Dave on Data

Our Alumni guest, that shared their experiences for a new community of scholars.

To all the student volunteers that made this possible, and the community of scholars for participating on the day.

Last but not least my wife and family who, listened to me when wasn't go as expected, and giving their support which allowed me to create this event.



Community Reactions



James Jan 24th at 9:07 AM

It's great to see you guys @Esmā, @Jonathan Papworth, @Ankita Ghosh, @Rachel_Kam, @birozso, @Gurpreet Kaur and other volunteers and leaders who made the program a success. Thanks for sacrificing a lot! It means a lot to us and we have come to appreciate your hard work. Thank you very much ❤️💜 (edited)

+1 6 🙌 5 👍 4 ❤️ 5 🌧️ 3 😊

#study_jam - Jan 23rd View in channel



Chirag 1:14 PM

Udacity Alumni AMA truly an AWESOME session. It was great to know Alumni stories and learn from their experiences. Great work @Jonathan Papworth and team 🙌😊👍

🔥 4 reactions

#study_jam - Jan 24th View in channel



Peace Peters 11:34 PM

Congratulations and a big thank you to the Study Jam team @Jonathan Papworth @Esmā and others for this amazing event!! 🎉👏
The webinars were insightful, really learned a lot from them particularly Scott & Susan's sessions 🔥👍 (edited)

🌧️🙌 8 reactions 🗨️ 8 replies

#study_jam - Jan 23rd View in channel



Yuhan Zhang 11:08 PM

yes! Dave is so amazing and inspiring!

🙌 1 reaction

#study_jam - Jan 24th



Tharuka 9:06 AM

Thank you to all the organizers and speakers for their tremendous effort to make this success... 🎉🙌👏

❤️🌧️ 7 reactions

#study_jam - Jan 23rd



Chirag 1:14 PM

Udacity Alumni AMA truly an AWESOME session. It was great to know Alumni stories and learn from their experiences. Great work @Jonathan Papworth and team 🙌😊👍

🔥 4 reactions

#study_jam - Jan 24th



Sarumi Bolatito 9:05 AM

Whao! What an eventful event. Thank you @Jonathan Papworth, @Esmā @Jessy Chen @Toxylee @Ebinbin Ajagun @Uzodimma. The last 24hrs is Totally worth it!!!

🙌🙌 10 reactions